

followup: Two peas in a Pod

Kicked about the cool features of the iPod in the December issue of Digit? If you're dying to check out the iPod, you don't need to spend a bomb on a Mac. Refer to XPod, a software being developed by Mediafour, which will allow Windows PCs to talk to iPods. It is in the pre-beta phase of developing XPod, which will allow FireWire-equipped Windows PCs to interact with the iPod (see www.mediafour.com for more information). XPod will be compatible with various flavours of Windows, from Windows 95 to XP, but will need version 7.0 or later of Microsoft's Windows Media Player (WMP). It may have a Windows Explorer-based interface for file

exchange in addition to plug-in functionality for WMP, but will not be able to transfer Windows Media Audio (WMA) to the iPod.

Meanwhile, here's more food for thought. Apple has confirmed a glitch in the iPod, which causes a small



percentage of the players to temporarily not wake from sleep when the battery reaches low charge level. Since there's no way to tell which iPod players have the problem, Apple recommends that all iPod owners download and install the update.

For those facing the problem, Apple suggests they make sure the hold switch is not on. Next, connect the unit to a power adapter or to a Mac, and then try to reset the device by holding down the Menu and Play buttons for 10 seconds. If this fails, disconnect the unit from its power source, let it sit unconnected for 24 hours and then reconnect to reset the machine.

BUGGED PHONES

The next time you receive an SMS on your Nokia phone, you might want to be extra careful. The message might just 'freeze' your phone, locking you out. How is this possible? By adapting a program `sms_client`, which sends an SMS message from an Internet-connected PC, with a broken User Data Header. Once the message is received, it is impossible to turn on an infected phone again without somehow deleting the offending message.

The Nokia models affected by this vulnerability are the Nokia 6210, 3310 and 3330. Nokia claims that it has fixed the flaw and that all phones rolling out of its plants are now secure. Users of older Nokia phones, however, might need to make a trip to that service centre nearby.

Paper future

Want to watch a movie? All you need to do is reach into your wallet and unfold the screen! A Dutch company, Philips Research, claims to have made a major improvement in the development of electronic display paper. This e-paper display uses active-

matrix technology, the kind used in good quality laptop computer displays, and is made of parts that use flexible plastic transistors instead of silicon. If produced in bulk, this is inexpensive to make and works well enough to constantly refresh a screen

to create moving images.

In addition, e-paper would need lesser power, will come in large sheets, offer higher contrast so that images are visible under varying lighting conditions, and would be durable enough to withstand regular use.

realitybites

"Despite what everyone says, our software is actually cheaper."

LARRY ELLISON

Oracle CEO
in a presentation at Oracle OpenWorld on Microsoft and IBM products being slower and less secure as well as more expensive than Oracle

Microsoft wasn't staying quiet:

"It's ironic to hear Larry claim they are price leaders in anything."

STAN SORESENSEN,

Microsoft's Director,
Enterprise Server Marketing

eventtracker

Smart Card Tech India 2002 Pragati Maidan, New Delhi, India www.exhibitionsindia.org/smart-card.html	National Conference on Industrial Automation & Intelligent Systems Chennai www.cdit.ac.in/conference.html
3G Mobile World Summit Tokyo, Japan http://www.marouservers.com/3g/	WirelessWorld Conference and Expo Singapore http://www.wirelessworld.com.sg

mid-2002 ■ China shuts down over 17,000 Internet bars for failing to block Web sites considered subversive or pornographic